Uni Notes

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Introduction

This document contains my personal notes from the courses I am taking at **Universitetet i Oslo**. It also includes some additional notes from my own independent studying, which are not directly part of the courses.

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§1 Commutative Algebra

1.1 Ideals

Theorem 1.1 **(The Fundamental Homomorphism Theorem)**
Let $\phi : A \to B$ be a homomorphism, then,

$$A/\ker\phi \cong \operatorname{im}\phi$$

Proof. Let $f(\alpha + \ker\phi) = \phi(\alpha)$. Then, notice this function is well defined, since, if $I = \alpha + \ker\phi = \beta + \ker\phi$, then we must show that,

$$\phi(\beta) = f(I) = \phi(\alpha)$$

Since $\alpha + \ker\phi = \beta + \ker\phi$ it must be that $\alpha + c = \beta + d$ and since $\ker\phi$ is an ideal it must be that $\alpha = \beta + \gamma$ where $\gamma \in \ker I$. Thus,

$$\phi(\alpha) = \phi(\beta + \gamma) = \phi(\beta) + \phi(\gamma) = \phi(\beta)$$

thus $\phi(\alpha) = \phi(\beta)$, so the function is well-defined.

Now, all that is left is to notice that if $x, y \in A/\ker\phi$, then,

$$f(x) \cdot f(y) = f(\alpha + \ker\phi) \cdot f(\beta + \ker\phi) = \phi(\alpha) \cdot \phi(\beta) = \phi(\alpha\beta) = f(xy)$$

$$f(x) + f(y) = \phi(\alpha) + \phi(\beta) = \phi(\alpha + \beta) = f(x + y)$$

thus f is a homomorphism, trivially it is surjective.

Let us show that f is injective, indeed if $f(\alpha + \ker\phi) = f(\beta + \ker\phi)$, then it must be that,

$$f(\alpha + \ker\phi) - f(\beta + \ker\phi) = f((\alpha - \beta) + \ker\phi) = 0 \implies \alpha - \beta \in \ker\phi$$

Thus, $\alpha \in \beta + \ker\phi$, thus it must be that $\alpha + \ker\phi = \beta + \ker\phi$, since $\ker\phi$ is known to be an ideal.

Thus, since f is a homomorphism which is both surjective and injective it must be that an isomorphism, thus proving the desired isomorphism.

■

This theorem is quite useful since it connects two objects which might at first glance seem unrelated.

You might of noticed sometimes people use $\mathbb{Z}_n$ and $\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z}$ interchangibly to represent arithmitic modulo n. Notice, if $\mathbb{Z}_n$ is modular arithmetic mod n, then if one considers the remainder function $\phi : \mathbb{Z} \to \mathbb{Z}_n$, then its ime is $\mathbb{Z}_n$ and the kerner is $n\mathbb{Z}$, thus by the Fundemental Homomorphism theorem it must be that,

$$\mathbb{Z}/n\mathbb{Z} \cong \mathbb{Z}_n$$

This is arguably a trivial example, however at least now you know what the two different notations mean!

Example 1.2 Let $\phi : \mathbb{Z}[X] \to \mathbb{C}$ be a homomorphism sending x to i, thus,

$$\phi\left(\sum_j a_j x^j\right) = \sum_j a_j i^j$$

Then, trivially $\operatorname{im}\phi = \mathbb{Z}[i]$, it is also not difficult to show that,

$$\ker\phi = (x^2+1)$$

Then, by the Fundemental Homomorphism Theorem it must be that $\mathbb{Z}[X]/(x^2+1) \cong \mathbb{Z}[i]$.

As an exercise let us prove the theorem described in the example,

Lemma 1.3 $\ker\phi = (x^2+1)$

Proof. Assume that $P(i) = 0$, then it must be that $P(x) = (x^2+1)Q(x)$, thus part of the ideal (x^2+1). ■

Now, another useful theorem about ideals is the following,

Theorem 1.4 Let A be a ring and $I \subseteq A$ an ideal, then there is an *order-preserving* bijection between,

$$\left\{\text{ideals in } A/I\right\} \leftrightarrow \left\{\text{ideals } J \text{ of } A \text{ such that } I \subseteq J\right\}$$

and the bijection is given by,

1. If $J \subseteq A/I$ is an ideal, then it is sent to $\phi^{-1}(J) \subseteq A$.
2. If $J \subseteq A$ such that $I \subseteq J$, then it is sent to $\phi(J)$.

where ϕ is the quotient homomorphism.

To mention a bit of notation, given a ring A the set of ideals $I \subseteq A$ is usually denoted as $\operatorname{Spec}(A)$.

1.2 Units and Fields

Definition 1.5 Let A be a ring, then $x \in A$ is,

1. A unit if there exists $y \in A$ such that,

$$xy = 1$$

2. A 0-divisor if there is $y \in A$,
$$xy = 0$$

Then,

Definition 1.6 Notice,

1. A ring A (non-zero) is a **field** if every $0 \neq x \in A$ is a unit.
2. A is an **integral domain** if $A \neq 0$ and the only 0-divisor of A is 0.

As an example in $\mathbb{Z}$ units are $\{1, -1\}$, thus not a *field*. However $\mathbb{Q}, \mathbb{R}, \mathbb{C}$ are *fields* and *integral domains*.

Lemma 1.7 The only integral domains of the form $\mathbb{Z}_n$ are $\mathbb{Z}_p$ for a prime p.

Notice,

Lemma 1.8 If $x \in A$, then, x is a unit is equivelent to $(x) = A$.

Proof. Indeed, since if x is a unit, then (x) trivially contains 1, thus generates the entire ring A.

If $(x) = A$, then $1 \in (x)$, thus $xy = 1$, thus x is a unit. ■

Another thing to notice,

Lemma 1.9 A is a field is equivalent to A having exactly two ideals (0) and (1).

Proof. If $I \neq (0)$ is an ideal in A, then since each element is a unit it contains 1, thus is equal to (1). ■

Now, let us prove two important statements,

Theorem 1.10 I is prime $\Leftrightarrow$ A/I is an integral domain.

Proof. Let us prove the statement both ways,

1. If $B = A/I$ is an integral domain, let ϕ be the quotient homomorphism. Then, if $xy \in I$, it must be that,
$$\phi(xy) = 0_B = \phi(x) \cdot \phi(y)$$
thus, either $\phi(x)$ or $\phi(y)$ is 0_B, which is equivelent to saying that either $x \in I$ or $y \in I$.

2. If I is prime, then let $B = A/I$, then suppose $xy = 0_B$ and ϕ is the quotient homomorphism. Then, let $a \in \phi^{-1}(x)$ and $b \in \phi^{-1}(y)$, then, $ab \in I$, consequently either a or b is in I which is equivelent to either x or y being 0_B.

■

Theorem 1.11 I is maximal $\Leftrightarrow$ A/I is a field.

Proof. Notice,

$$\left\{\text{ideals in } A/I\right\} \leftrightarrow \left\{\text{ideals } J \text{ of } A \text{ such that } I \subseteq J\right\}$$

thus since I is maximal it must be that A/I has only two ideals (0) and (1), which by the previous lemmas implies that A/I is a field. ■

1.3 Prime/Maximal Ideals and Krull's theorem

Let us consider the following,

Theorem 1.12 Let $I \subseteq J \subseteq A$, then J being prime in A is equivelent to J/I being prime in A/I.

Proof. One proof is to consider the bijection theorem described earlier, however there is another approach. Notice, J being prime is equivelent to A/J being an integral domain. Analougously J/I being prime in A/I is equivelent to showing that $(A/I)/(J/I)$ being an integral domain as well.

Thus, the problem is equivalent to showing that A/J being an integral domain is the same as showing that $(A/I)/(J/I)$ being an integral domain.

However, I claim that,

$$A/J \cong (A/I)/(J/I)$$

since if one considers the quotient homomorphism's $\phi : A \to A/I$ and $\psi : A/I \to (A/I)/(J/I)$, then, $\psi \circ \phi : A \to (A/J)/(I/J)$. Then,

$$\ker \psi \circ \phi = I$$

and $\psi \circ \phi$ is surjective (not difficult to show), consequently by the fundemental homomorphism theorem it must be that,

$$A/I = A/(\ker \psi \circ \phi) \cong \operatorname{im} \psi \circ \phi = (A/J)/(I/J)$$

■

Similarly one can show that J being maximal is equivelent to J/I beeing maximal in A/I. Notice another trivial property of prime/maximal ideals.

Lemma 1.13 Every *maximal* ideal is prime.

Proof. Since $I \subseteq A$ is maximal it must be that A/I is a field which is an integral domain which implies that I is prime. ■

There is quite a beautiful example of a maximal ideal,

Example 1.14 Let k be an arbitrary field and $\vec{a} = (a_1, \ldots, a_n)$ be some k-tuple of size n. Then, consider the *evaluation* homomorphism,

$$\phi_{\vec{a}} : k[x_1, \ldots, x_n] \to k$$

$$\phi_{\vec{a}} : f \mapsto f(\vec{a})$$

Then, I claim that $\ker_{\phi_{\vec{a}}} \subseteq k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$ is a maximal ideal. Since by the Fundamental Homomorphism theorem it must be that,

$$k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]/\ker_\phi \cong \operatorname{im} \phi = k$$

Thus, since k is a field it must be that $\ker_\phi$ is a maximal ideal in $k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$.

As it turns out we are actually always garanteed the existance of a maximal ideal within a ring by **Krull's theorem**.

Theorem 1.15 **(Krull's Theorem)** Let A be a ring $A \neq 0$, then A has a maximal ideal.

Proof. Let S be a poset on all ideals, where $I \geq J$ if $J \subseteq I$. Then, by Zorn's Lemma all that one must show is that every chain has an upper bound within S.

Let R be some chain of ideals, then consider the following ideal,

$$X = \bigcup_i R_i$$

keep it mind that in general not all unions of ideals are themselves an ideal, however in this case it is an ideal (trivial to verify the axioms). Now, notice that $X \neq (1)$, since if $X = (1)$ then that would mean that one of the R_i contains 1 since $1 \in (1)$, which would imply that some R_i is the entire ring, contradiction!

Consequently, since X is greater than all the elements in R we have established an upper bound of R for an abitrary chain R. Thus, by Zorn's lemma it must be that there exist maximal ideals! ■

We can use Krull's theorem to establish another useful property of ideals,

Lemma 1.16 If I is an ideal of A, then I is contained within some maximal ideal J.

Proof. Indeed, notice that by the bijection established earlier showing the existance of such a J is equivelent to finding a maximal ideal in A/I which exists by Krull's theorem. ■

Another useful property of maximal ideals are their relationship with units of the ring A,

Lemma 1.17 If x is a unit, then it is not contained in any maximal ideal I of a ring A.

Proof. If x is a unit, then there exists y such that $xy = 1$, consequently if $x \in I$ then by the aximos of ideals it must be that $1 \in I$ which implies that $I = (1) = A$, contradiction! ■

This leads us to an important piece of intuition that understanding the properties of units in a ring A is essentialy equivelent to understanding the properties of maximal ideals of A.

Lemma 1.18 Let A be a ring such that for every $x \in A$ there exists such a $n \in \mathbb{Z}$ such that $x^n = x$, prove that every prime ideal of A is maximal.

Proof. Let $I \subseteq A$ be a prime ideal, then in order to show that I is maximal, one must show that A/I is a field. Since I is a prime ideal we already know that A/I is an integral domain, meaning we must show that every element has a multiplicative inverse.

Let $x = \alpha + I \in A/I$ (for some $\alpha \neq 0$) then let us chose the minimal n such that (it exists by the problem statement),

$$(\alpha + I)^n = \alpha^n + I = \alpha + I$$

$$x^n - x = x(x^{n-1} - 1) = 0$$

thus since A/I is an integral domain it must be that $x^{n-1} = 1$, in other words there exists some m that $x^m = 1$ in A/I. Consequently $x \cdot x^{m-1} = 1$. Thus, since $m - 1 < n$ it must be that $x^{m-1} \neq x$, thus x has a multiplicative inverse.

Consequently A/I is a field and thus it must be that I is maximal. ■

1.4 Principle Ideal Domains & Unique Factorization Domains

The following natural definitions appear when dealing with rings,

Definition 1.19 A ring A is,

1. a *principle ideal domain* if every ideal $I \subseteq A$ is principle.
2. a *unique factorization domain* if every non-zero, non-unit is reducable.

Note, 0 is neither reducable or irreducable. Let us consider the following,

Lemma 1.20 If A is an integral domain and (f) is prime (where $f \neq 0$), then f is irreducable.

Proof. If (f) is prime, it must be that $(f) \neq (1)$ and consequently f is not a unit. Thus, assume that g, h are such that $f = gh$, then,

$$(f) = (gh) \implies g \in (f) \vee h \in (f)$$

WLOG $g \in (f)$, then it must be that $g = af$. Thus,

$$f = gh = (af) \cdot h = (ah) \cdot f$$

since A is an integral domain it must be that we can cancel f on both sides and obtain $ah = 1$, thus implying that h is a unit, contradiction! ■

Now, how to *precisely define* what it means for two factorizations to be equivelent. For example it would be nice to consider $2 \cdot 3 = (-2) \cdot (-3)$ as the same factorization of 6, thus the following definition is natural,

Definition 1.21 Two factorizations are equivelent,

$$a = \prod_i p_i = \prod_i q_i$$

if there is some bijection between p and q such that,

$$p_i = u_i q_i$$

where u_i is a unit.

Example 1.22 Due to the fundamental theorem of arithmetic it must be that $\mathbb{Z}$ is a UFD (unique factorization domain).

Consider $\mathbb{Z}[i\sqrt{5}]$ it is not a UFD since,

$$6 = (1 + i\sqrt{5})(1 - i\sqrt{5}) = 2 \cdot 3$$

Now, notice,

Lemma 1.23 If A is a UFD and $f \in A$ is irreducable, then (f) is prime.

Proof. Indeed, notice that f being irreducable implies that f is a non-unit, thus $(f) \neq (1)$.

Let $gh \in (f)$, then it must be that $gh = af$ for some $a \in A$. Notice, since f is irreducable it must be that in the factorization of g or h the element f is contained (possibly multiplied by some unit). WLOG g contains f in its factorization.

Then, $g \in (f)$, which implies that (f) is prime. ■

Here are two extremely useful results,

Theorem 1.24 Every PID is a UFD

Theorem 1.25 **(Gauss)** If A is a UFD, then $A[x]$ is a UFD as well.

This leads us to the following "chain" of inferences,

$$\text{field} \implies \text{PID} \implies \text{UFD} \implies \text{Integral Domain}$$

Now,

Lemma 1.26 A ring A is called *local* if it has exactly one maximal ideal.

Example 1.27 Every field is local, $\mathbb{Z}$ is not local.
The ring $\mathbb{Z}/p^i\mathbb{Z}$ is local. (a very nice example to keep in mind)

Now,

Lemma 1.28 Let A be a local ring with a maximal ideal $M \subset A$, then the units of A are $A \setminus M$.
A is local $\impliedby$ the set of non-unit is ideal.

Proof. The first point is a consequence of a lemma discussed earlier.
To prove the second statement, assume that A is a ring such that,

$$M = \{f \in A | f \text{ is not a unit}\}$$

is an ideal. Then,

$$M \text{ is a unique maximal ideal} \Leftrightarrow \text{every ideal } I \neq (1) \text{ is such that } I \subseteq M$$

Let $x \in I$, then $(x) \subseteq I \subseteq (1)$ since this holds for all $x \in I$ it must be that $I \subseteq m$. ■

Example 1.29 Consider,

$$\mathbb{R}(x) = \left\{\frac{f}{g} | f, g \in \mathbb{R}[x], g \neq 0\right\}$$

Then a subring

$$\mathbb{R}[x]_{(x)} = \left\{\frac{f}{g} | f, g \in \mathbb{R}[x] \text{ and } g \notin (x)\right\}$$

Then, it turns out that $\mathbb{R}[x]_{(x)}$ is local (basically the set of rational functions defined near

zero).

1.5 The Chinese Remainder Theorem

A known result in number theory is that if $(n, m) = 1$, then $ax + by$ can equal any integer. This allows us to define relatively prime elements in a commutative ring,

Definition 1.30 Ideals I and J are relatively prime if $I + J = (1)$.

Example 1.31 In $\mathbb{Q}[x]$ we can consider the principle ideals $(x-2)$ and $(2x^2-2)$, then,

$$(x-2)+(2x^2-2) = (x-2, 2x^2-2) = (x-2, 2x^2-2-2x^2+2x) = (x-2, 6) = (1)$$

thus proving that $(x-2)$ is relatively prime to $(2x^2-2)$.

Notice, if we consider $\mathbb{Z}$, then if we have some relatively prime ideals (2) and (3), then $(2)\cdot(3) = (6)$ which is just $(2)\cap(3)$, this leads one to question whether this is always true. It turns out it is,

Lemma 1.32 If $I, J \subseteq A$ are relatively prime, then $I \cdot J = I \cap J$.

Proof. One direction is trivial,

$$I \cdot J = \left\{ \sum_{i,j} a_i b_j \right\} \subseteq I \cap J$$

the other direction is no harder, assume that $c \in I \cap J$, then since I and J are relatively prime it must be that there exist some $a + b$ such that $a + b = 1$ where $a \in I$ and $b \in J$.

$$c = 1 \cdot c = (a+b)\cdot c = ac + bc \in I \cdot J$$

■

Let $A_1, \ldots, A_n$ be rings, then there is a natural definition of a *product* of these rings defined as,

$$\prod A_i = \{(a_1, \ldots, a_n) \mid a_i \in A_i\}$$

which is trivially a ring, where the operations are component-wise. Notice, we also have natural projection homomorphisms,

$$\phi_i : \prod_i A_i \to A_j$$

where $\phi_i((a_1, \ldots, a_n)) = a_i$. Another way to construct homomorphisms with ring products is to assume the existance of a homomorphism $\psi_i : B \to A_i$, then we can a product homomorphism defined as following,

$$\prod \psi_i : B \to \prod A_i$$

where $b \in B$ is sent to $(\psi_1(b), \ldots, \psi_n(b))$.

Now, we are ready to formulate the Generalized Chinese Remainder Theorem (sometimes written as CRT)

Theorem 1.33 **(The Chinese Remainder Theorem)**
Let $I_1, \ldots, I_n \subseteq A$ be ideals such that any two are coprime. Then,

$$A/\prod_i I_i \cong \prod A/I_i$$

Example 1.34 Consider the two coprime ideals $(x-2)$ and (x^2-2) in $\mathbb{Q}[x]$. Then,

$$\mathbb{Q}[x]/(x-2)(x^2-2) \cong \mathbb{Q}[x]/(x-2) \times \mathbb{Q}[x]/(x^2-2) \cong \mathbb{Q} \times \mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$$

where the last step can be done due to the fundamental homomorphism theorem.

Another useful notion is the following,

Definition 1.35 If $I, J \subseteq A$ are two ideals, then,

$$(I : J) = \{a \in A \mid aJ \subseteq I\}$$

then,

Definition 1.36 Let $J \subseteq A$ be an indeal, then the annihlator of J is,

$$\mathrm{Ann}(J) = ((0) : J) = \{a \in A \mid b \in J : ab = 0\}$$

similarly we can define the annihlator of an element $x \in A$,

$$\mathrm{Ann}(x) = \mathrm{Ann}((x))$$

1.6 Extension & Contraction of ideals

Definition 1.37 Let $I \subseteq A$ be an ideal of A, then the radical of I is defined as,

$$\sqrt{I} = \{f \in A \mid \exists n \in \mathbb{Z} : f^n \in I\}$$

For example in $\mathbb{Z}$ the radical of n simply looks at the prime factorization of n and turns all the exponents into 1 coinciding the standard definition of a radical in number theory.

Similarly, notice that $\sqrt{(0)}$ are simply all elements such that $x^n = 0$ for some n, i.e. the nilpotents of A.

Lemma 1.38 Let $I \subseteq A$ be an ideal, then $\sqrt{I}$ is an ideal.

Also, similarly to the formula charecterizing the set of nilpotents, the following theorem holds,

Theorem 1.39 If $I \subseteq A$ is an ideal, then,

$$\sqrt{I} = \bigcap_{\substack{P \subset A \\ P \text{ prime},\ I \subseteq P}} P$$

To prove this theorem we will first prove the following lemma,

Lemma 1.40 If $I \subseteq A$ is an ideal, let ϕ be the quotient homomorphism, let $N \subseteq A/I$ be the nilradical, then,

$$\sqrt{I} = \phi^{-1}(N)$$

Proof. Notice, $p \in \sqrt{I}$ is equivelent to $f^n \in I$ which is equivelent to $\phi(f^n) = 0$. Due to properties of homomorphisms it must be that,

$$\phi(f^n) = \phi(f)^n = 0$$

thus it must be that $\phi(f)$ is nilpotent in A/I, thus is in N. ■

Using this lemma we can prove for example that $\sqrt{I}$ is an ideal, since $\sqrt{I}$ is the preimage of an ideal which is an ideal. We can also use this lemma to prove the theorem giving a description of the radical.

Notice,

$$\phi^{-1}(N) = \phi^{-1}\left(\bigcap_{\substack{P \subset A/I \\ P \text{ prime}}} P\right) = \bigcap_{\substack{P \subseteq A/I \\ P \text{ prime}}} \phi^{-1}(P) = \bigcap_{\substack{Q \in A, \\ Q \text{ prime}, \\ I \subseteq Q}} Q$$

which proves the theorem (assuming that the nilradical theorem is proven which will be proven later on).

As mentioned before, while preimages behave nicely with ideals, the same is not true for images, this naturally leads us to the following definition,

Definition 1.41 Let $\phi : A \to B$ be a ring homomorphism, then let $I \subseteq A$, $J \subseteq B$, then,

- The **contraction** of J *along* ϕ is $\phi^{-1}(J)$
- The **extension** of I *along* ϕ, denoted as $\phi(I)B$ (or IB if ϕ is clear from the context) is the smallest ideal of B containing $\phi(I)$.

Notice,

Lemma 1.42 If $P \subset B$ is a prime ideal, then the contraction of P is also prime in A.

Proof. Indeed, assume that $xy \in \phi^{-1}(P)$, then,

$$\phi(x) \cdot \phi(y) = \phi(xy) \in \phi(\phi^{-1}(P)) = P$$

which implies that either $\phi(x) \in P$ or $\phi(y) \in P$ since P is prime. However, this means that either x or y is in $\phi^{-1}(P)$ which proves that $\phi^{-1}(P)$ is prime in A. ■

1.7 Modules & Free Modules and Quotient Modules

Definition 1.43 Let A be a ring, a module over A is a set M equiped with an operation $+ : M \times M \to M$ and a multiplication operation $\cdot : A \times M \to M$ such that,

1. $(M, +)$ is an Abelean group
2. $1_A m = m$
3. For any $a, b \in A$ and $m \in M$ it must be that $(a + b)m = am + bm$
4. For any $a \in A$ and $n, m \in M$ it must be that $a(n + m) = an + am$
5. $a(bm) = (ab)m$

As several examples, if A is a vector space, then modules over A is the same thing as a A vector space. Another beautiful thing is that any Abelian group is actually simply a $\mathbb{Z}$-module, since we can define the multiplication by an integer as repeated addition.

Notice, for $\mathbb{Z}$-modules group homomorphisms and module homomorphisms are the same thing!

Another important concept is direct summation,

Definition 1.44 Let M, N be A-modules, then,

$$N \oplus M = M \times N$$

in fact for any finite number of A-modules, $\{M_i\}$ the direct sum of the modules is the same as the product of modules. However, when considering an infinite direct sum, a restriction

on an element is added, that there is only a finite non-zero number of components.

Just as in vector spaces, a natural thing to do is to consider basis of modules. Trivially, some basis exists, since we can just consider all the elements, however what about uniqueness of expressability of each element in the module? Notice, the sums must be finite when spanning the module.

Let N be a A-module. Let the basis be E, then consider the homomorphism $\phi : A^{\oplus E} \to N$.

Notice, if f is not uniquely expressed as a linear combination of the basis elements, then we can consider the difference of the two linear combinations and thus obtain multiple representations of 0. Thus, in order for f to have the nice property of unique linear combinations it must be that $\ker \phi = 0$, in other words that ϕ is an isomorphism. Thus, that $N \cong A^{\oplus E}$. This motivates the following definition,

Definition 1.45 Let N be an A-module. Then N is **free** if $N \cong A^{\oplus \Lambda}$.

Notice, if A is some commutative ring, then any ideal $I \subseteq A$ is actually an A-module! Since we can consider quotient rings, this motivates one to consider quotient modules.

Definition 1.46 Let $N \subseteq M$ be a submodule, then,

$$M/N = \{m + N \mid m \in M\}$$

where the operations are defined canonically.

1.8 Module Isomorphism Theorems & Presentations of Modules

Just as in group theory there are fundamental isomorphism theorems there are module isomorphism theorems!

Theorem 1.47 **(Module Isomorphism Theorems)**

1. Let $\phi : M \to N$, then
$$\operatorname{im} \phi \cong M/\ker \phi$$
2. Given $M_1 \subseteq M_2 \subseteq M_3$, then we have,
$$M_3/M_2 \cong (M_3/M_1)/(M_2/M_1)$$
3. Given submodules $M, N \subseteq P$ we have,
$$(N + M)/M \cong N/(M \cap N)$$

Proof. I will only prove the third statement to showcase the power of the first statement. Consider the homomorphism $\phi : N \to (N+M)/M$ where $\phi(n) = n + M$, then ϕ is surjective

and $\ker\phi = M \cap N$, thus it must be that $(N+M)/M \cong N/(M\cap N)$. ■

If M is free, then $M \cong A^{\oplus\Lambda}$, then if Λ is finite, then the rank of M is simply the cardinality of Λ.

Lemma 1.48 Let M be an A-module. Then there exists some free module F and a surjective homomorphism $\phi : F \to M$.

Proof. Indeed, consider $A^{\oplus M}$, along with ϕ such that $\phi((a_m)_{m\in M}) = \sum_{m\in M} a_m m \in M$, then trivially ϕ is surjective, since for any $x \in A^{\oplus M}$ we can consider $e_x = (0, 0, \ldots, 1, \ldots, 0)$ where 1 is for the x element. ■

This lemma allows us to make the following definition,

Definition 1.49 Let M be an A-module, then the **presentation** of M are free modules F' and F along with a homomorphism $\phi : F' \to F$ where $M \cong \operatorname{cok}\phi$.

Notice,

Theorem 1.50 Any module has a presentation.

Proof. Indeed, by the lemma proven earlier it must be that there exists some surjective homomorphism $\phi : F \to M$ and some surjective homomorphism $\psi : F' \to \ker\phi$ (since $\ker\phi$ is also a module). Thus,

$$\psi : F' \to \ker\phi \subseteq F \xrightarrow{\phi} M$$

then,

$$\operatorname{cok}\psi = F/\operatorname{im}\psi = F/\ker\phi \cong \operatorname{im}\phi = M$$

which proves the existance of the desired presentation. ■

This means that a presentation can equivelently be defined as a set (G, R, ϕ, ψ) where G and R are some sets and $\phi : A^{\oplus R} \to A^{\oplus G}$ and $\psi : A^{\oplus G} \to M$ are homomorphisms such that ψ is surjective and $\operatorname{im}\phi = \ker\psi$. In other words a presentation of M is,

$$F' \xrightarrow{\phi} F \to M \to 0$$

Due to the rather complex definition of a **presentation** of a module it is rather useful to think of it as some generators and relations. Indeed, since F is free we can consider its basis, then the surjection $F \to M$ says that this basis *generates* M. Notice, the kernel of $F \to M$ consists of all linear combinations of the generators that vanish in M, these represent the *relations* between the generators.

This leads us to a rather intuitive understanding of a presentation to be simply a generalized notion of a basis for modules.

1.9 Nakayama's Lemma

Theorem 1.51 **(Nakayama's Lemma)** Let A be a *local* ring and M a finitely generated A-module. Then, if m is the maximal ideal of A, then if $mM = M$, then $M = 0$.

Proof. Assume that $mM = M$, then if $m_1, \ldots, m_n$ are the generators of M, then,

$$m_i = \sum_{j=1}^{n} a_{ij} m_j, \text{ where } a_{i,j} \in m$$

thus, notice that we can rewrite this as that for any i that,

$$a_{i1}m_1 + a_{i2}m_2 + \ldots + (a_{ii} - 1)m_i + \ldots + a_{in}m_n = 0$$

Let $T = (a_{ij})$ be a matrix. Then, this condition can be rewritten as,

$$T \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ m_2 \\ \ldots \\ m_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \ldots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

now multiplying both sides by $\text{adj}(T)$ we obtain,

$$\det(T) I_n \begin{pmatrix} m_1 \\ m_2 \\ \ldots \\ m_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} \det(T)m_1 \\ \det(T)m_2 \\ \ldots \\ \det(T)m_n \end{pmatrix} = \begin{pmatrix} 0 \\ 0 \\ \ldots \\ 0 \end{pmatrix}$$

however, notice that using the determinant can be expressed as using the Leibniz formula, then the main diagonal term is,

$$(a_{11} - 1)(a_{22} - 1) \ldots (a_{nn} - 1) = (-1)^n + X, \text{ where } X \in m$$

indeed, since any product of a_{ij} must lie in m due to it being closed under multiplication. All the other terms thus will also "cancel" and lie in m. Thus, $\det(T) = (-1)^n + Y$ where $Y \in m$, this implies that $\det(T) \notin m$ (since otherwise m is not proper). However, since A is local this must mean that $\det(T)$ is a unit. However,

$$\det(T)m_i = 0$$

which implies that $m_i = 0$ (since we can multiply both sides by $\frac{1}{\det(T)}$). This implies that $m_1 = \ldots = m_n = 0$ which implies that $M = 0$. ■

1.10 Additive functions & exact sequences

Definition 1.52 A *short* exact sequence is an exact sequence of the form,

$$0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$$

amusingly any short exact sequence has a well-behaved structure as the following lemma shows,

Lemma 1.53 If

$$0 \to M \xrightarrow{\phi} N \xrightarrow{\psi} P \to 0$$

is a short exact sequence of A-modules, then there exists an A-module $K \subset N$ such that $M \cong K$ and $P \cong N/K$.

Proof. Let $K = \operatorname{im} \phi$, then since ϕ is injective it must be that $M \cong K$. Now, due to the fundamental homomorphism theorem it must be that,

$$P = \operatorname{im} \psi \cong N/\ker \psi = N/K$$

which proves the desired result. ■

Definition 1.54 A function $v : \operatorname{Mod}_A \to G$ (where G is some abelian group) is additive if,

$$0 \to M' \to M \to M'' \to 0$$

being exact implies that $v(M) = v(M') + v(M'')$.

a trivial example is that when A is a field, then $v(M) = \dim_e(M)$ is an additive function, however there is another more interesting example,

Example 1.55 Let S be all finite $\mathbb{Z}$-module (i.e. finite abelian groups), let $v : S \to (\mathbb{Q}^\star, \cdot)$ be defined as simply the cardinality of the given $\mathbb{Z}$-module. Then, notice that due to a previously proven lemma we know that a short exact sequence must be of the form,

$$0 \to N \to M \to M/N \to 0$$

then by Lagrange's theorem we know that $|M/N| \cdot |N| = |M|$ which proves that v is additive in $(\mathbb{Q}^\star, \cdot)$.

Theorem 1.56 Let v be an additive function defined all the submodules of $M_1, \ldots, M_n$ and the modules themselves, let,

$$0 \to M_1 \to \ldots \to M_n \to 0$$

be exact then,

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n}(-1)^i v(M_i) = 0$$

Proof. To prove this rather interesting theorem we will first prove the following lemma,

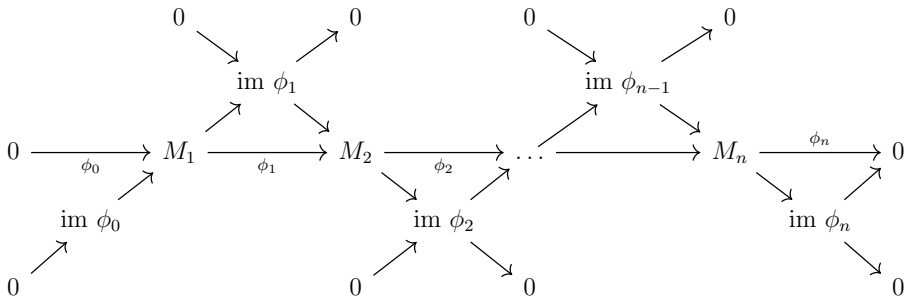
Lemma 1.57 Let $M' \xrightarrow{\phi} M \xrightarrow{\psi} M''$ be exact, then,

$$0 \to \operatorname{im}\phi \to M \to \operatorname{im}\psi \to 0$$

is exact.

Proof. Per definition the homomorphism between M and $\operatorname{im}\psi$ is surjective, proving exactness of the later sequence at $\operatorname{im}\psi$. Analogously the canonical homorphism between $\operatorname{im}\phi$ and M is injective. Exactness at M means that $\operatorname{im}\phi = \ker\psi$, however that follows from the exactness of the original sequence. ■

Consequently we can draw the following monsterous diagram,



it must be exact. Thus, we know that,

$$v(\operatorname{im}\phi_i) + v(\operatorname{im}\phi_{i+1}) = v(M_{i+1})$$

thus we see that,

$$\sum_{i=1}^{n}(-1)^i v(M_i) = 0$$

which proves the theorem. ■

§2 Galois Theory

An import concept related to fields is,

Definition 2.1 K is a *field extension* of F if $K \subseteq F$, where K and F are fields, usually denoted as K/F.

A natural concept to consider from here is,

Definition 2.2 An *algebraic closure* of a field F is the minimal *field extension* K of F such that for all $P(X) \in F[X]$ the roots of P lie in K.

As an example the *algebraic closure* of $\mathbb{Q}$ are algebraic numbers and the *algebraic closure* of $\mathbb{R}$ is $\mathbb{C}$.

Let *embedding* be an *injective field homomorphism* $f : K \hookrightarrow \mathbb{C}$ which fixes $\mathbb{Q}$. Then,

Lemma 2.3 Under an *embedding* an element gets sent to one of its Galois conjugates.

Proof. Let us consider the minimal polynomial over $\mathbb{Q}$, then,

$$a_1 + a_2\alpha + \ldots + a_n\alpha^n = 0$$

Then, applying an embedding f to both sides we obtain,

$$f(a_1) + f(a_2)f(\alpha) + \ldots + f(a_n)f(\alpha)^n = f(0)$$

$$a_1 + a_2 f(\alpha) + \ldots + a_n f(\alpha)^n = 0$$

Thus, $f(\alpha)$ is a root of the minimal polynomial, thus one of the Galois conjugates of α by definition. ■

This lemma actually tells us a lot about the behaviour of *embeddings*. Consider $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$, since the minimal polynomial of $\sqrt{2}$ is $x^2 - 2 = 0$ which contains two roots, thus a *embedding* can send $\sqrt{2}$ only to one of those two roots, then the rest of the function is determined. Consequently there are only 2 embeddings of $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$.

In general the same logic can be applied to derive that the number of embeddings $f : \mathbb{Q}(\alpha) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is simply the *algebraic degree* of α.

Actually a more general theorem holds,

Theorem 2.4 The number of embeddings $f : K \hookrightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is precisely the degree of field $K/\mathbb{Q}$.

Proof. Let $K = \mathbb{Q}(a_1, \ldots, a_n)$. Then, the number of embeddings $f : \mathbb{Q}(a_1, \ldots, a_k) \hookrightarrow \mathbb{C}$ is simply,

$$[\mathbb{Q}(a_1, \ldots, a_k) : \mathbb{Q}(a_1, \ldots, a_{k-1})] \ldots [\mathbb{Q}(a_1, a_2) : \mathbb{Q}(a_1)] \cdot [\mathbb{Q}(a_1) : \mathbb{Q}] \\ = [\mathbb{Q}(a_1, \ldots, a_k) : \mathbb{Q}] = [K : \mathbb{Q}]$$

which proves the desired result. ■

The logic here is quite general, thus it can be generalized further to abritrary algebraic closures, all that is required is that a polynomial being irreducable implies that it doesn't have double roots (this is allowed since we are working in an algebraic closure). A more general theorem holds, the proof is trivially the same,

Theorem 2.5 Let K/F be an a field extension and let G be an algebraic closure of F, then there exist $[K : F]$ embeddings $\sigma : K \to G$ that fix F.

Now, given a field extension K/F we can consider the group of automorphisms from K/F to itself. Then,

Lemma 2.6 $|\operatorname{Aut}(K/F)|$ divides $[K : F]$

Proof. TODO (Consequence of Lagrange) ■

Notice, that we can determine $|\operatorname{Aut}(K/F)|$ given $K = F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$, since α has to go to its Galois conjugates, however since it is an automorphism those roots must go to the roots which are in K. To provide several examples,

1. $|\operatorname{Aut}(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})/\mathbb{Q})| = 2$, since the Galois conjugates of $\sqrt{2}$ are $-\sqrt{2}$ and $\sqrt{2}$ both of which lie in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})$. Thus it is also true that $\operatorname{Aut}(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt{2})/\mathbb{Q}) \cong \mathbb{Z}/2\mathbb{Z}$.
2. $|\operatorname{Aut}(\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[3]{2})/\mathbb{Q})| = 1$, since the Galois conjugates of $\sqrt[3]{2}$ are complex, the only one in $\mathbb{Q}(\sqrt[3]{2})$ being $\sqrt[3]{2}$, thus there is only one automorphism, and it is the identity function.

Notice,

Theorem 2.7 Let K/F be a finite seperable field extension and let $K/F = F(\alpha_1, \ldots, a_h)$. Then, let $\mu(\alpha)$ be the number of Galois conjugates of α present in K/F. Then,

$$|\operatorname{Aut}(K/F)| \leq \prod_{i=1}^{h} \mu(\alpha_i)$$

Proof. Since each of the generators may be sent to one of the $\mu(\alpha_i)$ elements, we obtain the desired result. (notice inequality is important since not any configurtion gives rise to a valid automorphism) ■

However, it turns out that due to **Artin's primitive element theorem** that all finite seperable field extensions have the minimal generator set of size 1, i.e. $K/F = F(\alpha)$ for some $\alpha \in K$, thus reducing the above theorem to just one factor.

Now, this discussion naturally leads to the following definition,

Definition 2.8 A finite field extension K/F is a Galois field extension if and only if,

$$|\operatorname{Aut}(K/F)| = [K : F]$$

Notice, if $K/F = F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$, then,

$$|\operatorname{Aut}(K/F)| = [F(a_1, \ldots, a_k) : F(a_1, \ldots, a_{k-1})] \cdot \ldots \cdot [F(a_1) : F] = [K : F]$$

the only condition required for this proof to work is that K/F is *normal* (i.e. given any irreducable polynomial $p \in F[X]$ with at least one root in K/F it splits completely in K/F) and seperable, thus we obtain the following,

Theorem 2.9 If a field extension is seperable and *normal*, then it is a Galois field extension.

obviously the definitions are now equivelent. However, it turns out there is another way to define a Galois extension, an equivelent formulation,

Theorem 2.10 A field extension K/F is Galois if and only if it is a splitting field of some separable polynomial $p \in F[X]$.

The proof for why $K/F = \operatorname{Spl}_F(p)$ implies K/F is Galois is the exact same the one one provided above, since the minimal polynomials of a_i all split since p splits. The other direction is a bit trickier, thus I will not provide the proof of this statement.

When a field extension K/F is Galois, the group of automorphisms on it is denoted as $\operatorname{Gal}(K/F)$ and called the Galois group of K/F.

Similarly one can define a *Galois closure* of K/F which is the minimal field extension L/K such that L/F is a Galois field extension, where minimality means any other field extension satisfying this property contains L.

It turns out constructing Galois closure's isn't that difficult, in fact,

Theorem 2.11 Suppose $K = F(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$, then the Galois closure L is,

$$L = \operatorname{Spl}_F(m_1, \ldots, m_n)$$

where m_i is the minimal polynomial of α_i.

Proof. Notice, trivially $K \subseteq L$ since $(\alpha_1, \ldots, \alpha_n)$ all must be present in L since the minimal polynomials contain α_i as roots.

Notice, L/F is a seperable and normal field extension, thus a Galois field extension.

It is minimal, since the Galois closure must be seperable and normal it must be the roots of the minimal polynomials of α_i are present in the Galois closure, thus we obtain that any Galois closure must contain L.

Consequently, we obtain the the Galois closure of K/F is simply the splitting field of the minimal polynomials of the generators of K/F. ■

§3 Algebraic Topology

3.1 Homology of the Suspension

Let us first show the following result,

Theorem 3.1 $\tilde{H}_n(SX) \cong \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X)$

Proof. Observe,

Lemma 3.2 $\mathrm{H}_n(X, A) \cong \tilde{H}_n(X \cup CA)$

This follows from Excision since,

$$\tilde{H}_n(X \cup CA) \cong H_n(X \cup CA, CA) \cong H_n(X \cup CA \setminus \{p\}, CA \setminus \{p\}) \cong H_n(X, A)$$

where the first isomorphism follows from CA being contractible! □

Observe that since $SX = CX \bigcup_X CX$, thus by the lemma we know that $\tilde{H}_n(SX) \cong H_n(CX, X)$ and by the long reduced homology chain,

$$\ldots \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(CX) \longrightarrow H_n(CX, X) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_{n-1}(CX) \longrightarrow \ldots$$

and since $\tilde{H}_n(CX)$ is zero (since CX is contractible) we conclude the desired result! ■

Now let us explore the problem more generally, let C^kX be k copies of CX glued over X.

Theorem 3.3 $\tilde{H}_n(C^kX) \cong \bigoplus_{i=1}^{k-1} \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X)$

Proof. Let us decompose $C^kX = CX \cup C^{k-1}X$, then $CX \cap C^{k-1}X = X$, thus by the Mayer–Vietoris sequence we obtain,

$$\ldots \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(X) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(C^{k-1}X) \oplus \tilde{H}_n(CX) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(C^kX) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X) \longrightarrow \ldots$$

since CX is contractible the $\tilde{H}_n(CX)$ term disappears. Let us closely look at the map $\tilde{H}_n(X) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(C^{k-1}X)$, clearly this induces the zero map (via the inclusion $X \hookrightarrow C^{k-1}X$) since every cycle in X becomes contractible in $C^{k-1}X$, thus we obtain the short exact sequence,

$$0 \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(C^{k-1}X) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_n(C^kX) \longrightarrow \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X) \longrightarrow 0$$

now to apply the *Split Lemma* we try to construct the inverse map which we can do since for the first map simply consider the map that maps the last cone into the first one. Thus,

$$\tilde{H}_n(C^k X) \cong \tilde{H}_n(C^{k-1}X) \oplus \tilde{H}_{n-1}(X)$$

thus by induction we obtain the desired result! ■

Remark 3.4 A much simpler approach can be obtained by observing that $C^k X \simeq C^k X / C_1 X$ (choosing an arbitrary cone $C_1 X$) thus when collapsed will collapse X and thus $C^k X \simeq \bigvee_{i=1}^{k-1} SX$, thus by the previous lemma we obtain the desired result.

3.2 Euler Charecteristic

Given a space X with a CW structure, let us define the *Euler Charecteristic* of the space as,

$$\chi(X) = \sum_i (-1)^i n_i(X)$$

where $n_i(X)$ counts the number of i-cells of X.

Theorem 3.5 $\chi(X) = \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{rank} H_i(X)$

Proof. Let us start by looking at the cellular chain complex,

$$\ldots \longrightarrow C_{n+1} \xrightarrow{\delta_{n+1}} C_n \xrightarrow{\delta_n} C_{n-1} \longrightarrow \ldots \longrightarrow C_0 \longrightarrow 0$$

where $C_n = H_n(X^n, X^{n-1})$. Let $A_n = \ker \delta_n$ and $B_n = \operatorname{im} \delta_n$, then by the fundamental isomorphism theorem and the definition of a homology we have two exact short sequences (since we know that that the cellular homology is isomorphic to the singular homology for CW-complexes),

$$\begin{cases} 0 \longrightarrow A_n \longrightarrow C_n \longrightarrow B_n \longrightarrow 0 \\ 0 \longrightarrow B_{n+1} \longrightarrow A_n \longrightarrow H_n \longrightarrow 0 \end{cases}$$

now taking the ranks of the two equations we obtain that (since the rank is *additive*),

$$\operatorname{rank} C_n = \operatorname{rank} A_n + \operatorname{rank} B_n = \operatorname{rank} B_{n+1} + \operatorname{rank} B_n + \operatorname{rank} H_n$$

Thus,

$$\begin{aligned} \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{rank} H_n = \sum_i (-1)^i \Big(\operatorname{rank} \operatorname{im} \delta_{n+1} + \operatorname{rank} \operatorname{im} \delta_n + \operatorname{rank} H_n \Big) \\ = \sum_i (-1)^i \operatorname{rank} C_n = \sum_i (-1)^i n_i(X) \end{aligned}$$

since $\operatorname{rank} \operatorname{im} \delta_0 = \operatorname{rank} 0 = 0$ and the last equality is due to $C_k \cong H_k(X^k, X^{k-1})$ which is isomorphic to the k-homology of the wedge sum of n_k k-spheres and thus a rank of n_k! ■

Remark 3.6 Note that the $\operatorname{rank} C_n$ argument in the end can be more directly written as,

$$\operatorname{rank} H_k(X^k, X^{k-1}) = \operatorname{rank} H_k\left(\bigvee_{i=1}^{n_k(X)} S^k\right) = \operatorname{rank} \bigoplus_{i=1}^{n_k(X)} H_k(S^k) = \operatorname{rank} \mathbb{Z}^{n_k(X)} = n_k(X)$$

The remarable aspect is that the homology groups do not depend on the CW structure imposed on X, since singular homology is the same as simplicial for CW complexes.

3.3 Poincare Duality

Let us prove the following result,

Theorem 3.7 Given any orientable compact manifold X (n-dimensional) we have that $H^k(X) \cong H_{n-k}(X)$.

It turns out, that proving this result is more natural by proving an even more general result,

Theorem 3.8 Given any R-orientable manifold X (n-dimensional) it holds that $H^k_C(X; R) \cong H_{n-k}(X; R)$, where the isomorphism is given by the cap product with the fundamental class (i.e. induced by $\varphi \mapsto \varphi \frown \mu_K$ on $H^k(X \mid K; R)$ for compact $K \subseteq X$).

Trivially, per definition of cohomology with compact support one has Theorem 3.7 as a special case for compact manifolds. The usefuless of this more general statement boils down to the capability to perform *induction* on open sets, since compactness allows us to extract finite covers.

The R-orientability condition is what allows the proof to work, another important result that will be heavily used is the following.

Proposition Given any R-orientable n-manifold M and any compact $K \subseteq M$, there exists a **unique** fundamental class $\mu_K \in H_n(M \mid K; R)$ such that the image of μ_K under the inclusion map $H_n(M \mid K; R) \to H_n(M|x; R)$ goes to the orientation of M at x for all $x \in K$.

The main element of the proof of the theorem is the following commutative (up to sign) diagram.

Lemma 3.9 Given any open sets U and V, let $M = U \cup V$, then the following diagram

is commutative (up to sign),

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
\ldots & \longrightarrow & H_C^k(U\cap V) & \longrightarrow & H_C^k(U)\oplus H_C^k(V) & \longrightarrow & H_C^k(M) & \longrightarrow & H_C^{k+1}(U\cap V) & \longrightarrow & \ldots \\
 & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \downarrow & & \\
\ldots & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(U\cap V) & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(U)\oplus H_{n-k}(V) & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(M) & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k-1}(U\cap V) & \longrightarrow & \ldots
\end{array}$$

Thus, observe that if we know the theorem to be true for U, V and $U\cap V$ it must be true for $U\cup V$ (by the Five Star Lemma since almost all the vertical arrows in the diagram above will become isomorphisms), thus all that would be left is to verify the lemma for the *base open sets* of the manifold, which amounts to only verifying it for $\mathbb{R}^n$ (since locally a manifold is homeomorphic it).

Let us now attempt to prove the lemma. The first step is to use the definition of the cohomology with compact support via the colimit of relative cohomologies, thus obtaining the diagram. Let $K\subset U$ and $L\subset V$ be two compact subsets, then consider the diagram below,

$$\begin{array}{ccccccccc}
\ldots & \longrightarrow & H^k(M\mid K\cap L) & \longrightarrow & H^k(M\mid K)\oplus H^k(M\mid L) & \longrightarrow & H^k(M\mid K\cup L) & \longrightarrow & \ldots \\
 & & \downarrow\cong & & \downarrow\cong & & \downarrow\cong & & \\
\ldots & \longrightarrow & H^k(U\cap V\mid K\cap L) & \longrightarrow & H^k(U\mid K)\oplus H^k(V\mid L) & \longrightarrow & H^k(M\mid K\cup L) & \longrightarrow & \ldots \\
 & & \downarrow & \textcircled{1} & \downarrow & \textcircled{2} & \downarrow & \textcircled{3} & \\
\ldots & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(U\cap V) & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(U)\oplus H_{n-k}(V) & \longrightarrow & H_{n-k}(M) & \longrightarrow & \ldots
\end{array}$$

where the vertical isomorphisms come from the Excision axiom. Showing commutativity of this diagram (up to sign) will result in commutativity of its corresponding colimit diagram of desire. The proof requires showing commutativity of the three boxes 1, 2 and 3.

Proposition 3.10 The 1st square commutes (from here on I will omit clarrifying that it is up to sign).

Proof. Indeed, if $\varphi\in H^k(M\mid K\cap L)$, then the left-down path results in $\varphi\frown\mu_{K\cap L}\in H_{n-k}(U\cap V)$. Mapping this result across the bottom horizontal arrow (which is induced by the inclusions $i_U: U\cap V\hookrightarrow U$ and $i_V: U\cap V\hookrightarrow V$) yields $(i_{U*}(\varphi\frown\mu_{K\cap L}), -i_{V*}(\varphi\frown\mu_{K\cap L}))$ in $H_{n-k}(U)\oplus H_{n-k}(V)$.

$$\begin{array}{ccc} H_n(U\cap V \mid K\cap L) & \xrightarrow{i_U^*\varphi\frown -} & H_{n-k}(U\cap V) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle i_{U*}} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle i_{U*}} \\ H_n(U \mid K\cap L) & \xrightarrow[\varphi\frown -]{} & H_{n-k}(U) \end{array}$$

By the naturality of the cap product with respect to continuous maps, we have the identity $i_{U*}(i_U^*\varphi \frown \mu_{K\cap L}) = \varphi \frown i_{U*}(\mu_{K\cap L})$. Thus, per uniqueness of the fundamental class $i_{U*}(\mu_{K\cap L})$ is the image of μ_K under $H_n(U \mid K) \to H_n(U \mid K\cap L)$ and $i_{V*}(\mu_{K\cap L})$ is the image of μ_L under $H_n(V \mid L) \to H_n(V \mid K\cap L)$. Following the right-down path, the top horizontal map restricts φ to $(\varphi, -\varphi)$. Pushing this down via the cap product (using naturality once more for $(U, U-K) \hookrightarrow (U, U-K\cap L)$ and similarly for V) directly yields $(\varphi\frown\mu_K, -\varphi\frown\mu_L)$, thus the box commutes! ■

Proposition 3.11 The 2nd square commutes.

Proof. The top horizontal map is given by $(\alpha,\beta)\mapsto\alpha+\beta$, thus one needs to show that $\alpha\frown\mu_K + \beta\frown\mu_L = (\alpha+\beta)\frown\mu_{K\cup L}$ in $H_{n-k}(M)$, which follows from $\mu_{K\cup L}$ mapping to μ_K and μ_L under $H_n(M \mid K\cup L)\to H_n(M\mid K)$ and $H_n(M\mid K\cup L)\to H_n(M\mid L)$ respectively (by uniqueness of the fundamental class), naturality and distributivity of the cap product. ■

The third square is in some sense the hardest to prove.

Proposition 3.12 The 3rd box commutes.

Proof. Let us explicitly consider the square with the Excision maps,

$$\begin{array}{ccc} & & H^{k+1}(M \mid K\cap L) \\ & \overset{\delta}{\nearrow} & \downarrow{\scriptstyle\cong} \\ H^k(M\mid K\cup L) & \longrightarrow & H^{k+1}(U\cap V \mid K\cap L) \\ \downarrow{\scriptstyle\mu_{K\cup L}\frown} & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle\mu_{K\cap L}\frown} \\ H_{n-k}(M) & \xrightarrow{\partial} & H_{n-k-1}(U\cap V) \end{array}$$

Let us consider an arbitrary element $\varphi\in H^k(M|K\cup L)$, then the Mayer–Vietoris map is given by writing $\varphi=\varphi_U+\varphi_V$ (where φ_U vanishes on chains in $M-K$ and φ_V vanishes on chains in $M-L$), then since $\delta\varphi=\delta\varphi_U+\delta\varphi_V=0$ (since φ is a cocycle) we know that $\delta\varphi_U=-\delta\varphi_V$, which implies that both vanish on chains in $M-K\cap L$, then $\varphi\mapsto\delta\varphi_U$.

The trick is to expand $\mu_{K\cup L}$ via barycentric subdivision by considering the open cover $M=(U-L)\cup(V-K)\cup(U\cap V)$, then we may write,

$$\mu_{K\cup L}=\alpha_{U-L}+(\alpha_{V-K}+\alpha_{U\cap V})$$

where the second term clearly lies in V, thus will be ignored by the Mayer-Vietoris map. Thus, the top-right path to $H_{n-k-1}(U \cap V)$ will be given by $\mu_{K\cap L} \frown \delta\varphi_U$. To find the bottom path result, let us first apply the vertical cap product,

$$\mu_{K\cup L} \frown \varphi = \alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi + (\alpha_{V-K} + \alpha_{U\cap V}) \frown \varphi$$

observe how the second term lies in V, thus may be ignored (under the Mayer-Vietoris map), thus applying ∂ we obtain,

$$\partial(\alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi) = (-1)^{k+1}(\partial\alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi - \alpha_{U-L} \frown \delta\varphi) = (-1)^{k+1}(\partial\alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi)$$

again we may replace φ by φ_U since $\partial\alpha_{U-L}$ lies in $M - L$ where φ_V vanishes and thus obtain $(-1)^{k+1}(\partial\alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi_U)$.

To connect this to the top path, observe that the sum $\alpha_{U-L} + \alpha_{U\cap V}$ represents the fundamental class μ_K. Since $\partial(\alpha_{U-L} + \alpha_{U\cap V}) = \partial\mu_{K\cup L} - \partial\alpha_{V-K}$ lies in $M - K$ and φ_U vanishes on chains in $M - K$, we have the relation $\partial(\alpha_{U-L} + \alpha_{U\cap V}) \frown \varphi_U = 0$, which forces the identity $\partial\alpha_{U-L} \frown \varphi_U = -\partial\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U$ which further simplifies our bottom path as $(-1)^{k+2}(\partial\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U)$.

Thus, we only need to show that $\mu_{K\cap L} \frown \delta\varphi_U = \pm(\partial\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U)$, and since $\alpha_{U\cap V}$ represents $\mu_{K\cap L}$ (its boundary lies in $M - K \cap L$ and α_{U-L}, α_{V-K} avoid $K \cap L$), we only need to show that $\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \delta\varphi_U$ and $\partial\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U$ have the same homology classes in $H_{n-k-1}(U \cap V)$, to do this consider the chain $\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U$ in $U \cap V$, then their difference is a boundary,

$$\partial(\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U) = (-1)^{k+1}(\partial\alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \varphi_U - \alpha_{U\cap V} \frown \delta\varphi_U)$$

which implies the desired result! ■

Now, let us perform the final induction step. Let us show the theorem for any open $Y \subset \mathbb{R}^n$, observe that we first need the following.

Lemma 3.13 If $M = \bigcup_i U_i$ for a directed family of open sets U_i (e.g. $U_1 \subseteq U_2 \subseteq \ldots$) and D_{U_i} is an isomorphism for all i, then so is D_M.

Proof. Every compact $K \subseteq M$ lies in some U_i, thus $H^k_C(M; R) = \varinjlim H^k_C(U_i; R)$, and since every singular chain has compact image also $H_{n-k}(M; R) = \varinjlim H_{n-k}(U_i; R)$. The maps D_{U_i} commute with the inclusions (by naturality of the cap product, as in the 1st square), thus $D_M = \varinjlim D_{U_i}$ is a colimit of isomorphisms, hence an isomorphism. ■

We now proceed in three steps.

1. Y **convex.** Then $Y \cong \mathbb{R}^n$ and every compact set lies in a closed ball B, thus $H^k_C(\mathbb{R}^n; R) = \varinjlim_B H^k(\mathbb{R}^n \mid B; R)$ where $H^k(\mathbb{R}^n \mid B; R) \cong \tilde{H}^{k-1}(S^{n-1}; R)$ is R for $k = n$ and 0 otherwise (with all maps in the colimit isomorphisms). For $k = n$, μ_B generates $H_n(\mathbb{R}^n \mid B; R)$, so by universal coefficients we may pick φ with $\varphi(\mu_B) = 1$, then $\varphi \frown \mu_B$ is a generator of $H_0(\mathbb{R}^n; R) \cong R$, thus D_Y is an isomorphism.

2. $Y = U_1 \cup \ldots \cup U_m$ **with** U_i **convex.** Let $U = U_1 \cup \ldots \cup U_{m-1}$ and $V = U_m$, then $U \cap V = (U_1 \cap U_m) \cup \ldots \cup (U_{m-1} \cap U_m)$ is a union of $m-1$ convex sets, thus by induction on m the theorem holds for U, V and $U \cap V$, hence by the Mayer–Vietoris lemma and the five lemma also for Y.

3. Y **arbitrary open.** Y is a union of countably many open balls $B_1, B_2, \ldots$ (rational centers and radii), thus $Y = \bigcup_m Y_m$ with $Y_m = B_1 \cup \ldots \cup B_m$ increasing, each Y_m is covered by step 2, and we conclude by the lemma above.

Finally, for a general M consider the collection of open $U \subseteq M$ for which D_U is an isomorphism, ordered by inclusion. It is non-empty (it contains every chart by step 3) and every chain has an upper bound, namely its union (by the directed union lemma), thus by Zorn's lemma there is a maximal such U. If $U \neq M$, pick a chart $V \cong \mathbb{R}^n$ around a point of $M - U$, then V and $U \cap V$ (an open subset of $V \cong \mathbb{R}^n$) satisfy the theorem by step 3, hence by the Mayer–Vietoris lemma and the five lemma so does $U \cup V \supsetneq U$, contradicting maximality. Thus $U = M$. ■

§4 1-Categories (based on Farum lectures)

Let us have two sets X_0 and X_1, then a category is a collection equipped with a composition map $X_1 \times_{X_0} X_1 \overset{\circ}{\to} X_1$,

$$\begin{cases} X_0 \overset{s_0}{\to} X_1 \\ X_1 \overset{d_0}{\to} X_0 \\ X_1 \overset{d_1}{\to} X_0 \end{cases}$$

then we usually call X_0 to be the *objects* and X_1 the *morphisms* of the category.

Example 4.1 If X_0 is the collection of sets and X_1 is the collection of functions between sets, let,

1. d_0 target map
2. d_1 source map
3. s_0 is the identity map

Example 4.2 Let X_0 be the collection of groups and X_1 group homomorphisms, then we can define d_0, d_1 and s_0 in the same way as done with the sets.

Example 4.3 Similarly we can have the category of topological spaces, were X_0 are topoligcal spaces and X_1 are continous maps.

Now let us define the Hom-functor,

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) = \{f \in X_1 \mid d_1 f = x,\ d_0 f = y\}$$

Example 4.4 If we have a poset $(X, \leq)$, then take,

$$\mathrm{Hom}(x, y) = \begin{cases} \star, & \text{if } x \leq y \\ \emptyset, & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

indeed since if $x \leq y \wedge y \leq z \implies x \leq z$ and we know that s_0 (the identity) is true since $x \leq x$ and it commutes with the rest of the category.

Now take X_0 to be one object, then let X_1 be the elements of the group. The functions d_0 and d_1 are just constant, and the identity map s_0 sends the single object to the identity element of the group. This category will be denoted by $\mathcal{B}G$.

Definition 4.5 Given categories $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$, then a functor from $\mathcal{C}$ to $\mathcal{D}$ is map $F : \text{Ob}\ \mathcal{C} \to \text{Ob}\ \mathcal{D}$ and for every $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$ there is a map $F : \text{Mor}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) \to \text{Mor}_{\mathcal{D}}(F(X), F(Y))$.

The functor F must satisfy the following axioms,

1. If $X \xrightarrow{f} Y, Y \xrightarrow{g} Z$ then we have,
$$F(g) \circ F(f) = F(g \circ f)$$
2. For all $X \in \text{Ob}\ \mathcal{C}$ it must be that $F(\text{id}_x) = \text{id}_{F(X)}$

Let us consider a functor F from **Group** to **Set**, this can be done by just mapping every homomorphism to a function between the sets, this is called the *forgetful* functor.

Example 4.6 Notice that a group action F of a group G on a set S is a functor $\mathcal{B}G \xrightarrow{F} \text{Set}$.

Definition 4.7 $\mu : F \to G$ is a natural transformation if it assigns to each $X \in \text{Ob}\ \mathcal{C}$ a morphism $\mu_X : F(X) \to G(X)$ in $\mathcal{D}$ such that for every $f : X \to Y$ in $\mathcal{C}$, the following square commutes:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} F(X) & \xrightarrow{\mu_X} & G(X) \\ {\scriptstyle F(f)}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle G(f)} \\ F(Y) & \xrightarrow{\mu_Y} & G(Y) \end{array}$$

Example 4.8 Let us fix two categories $\mathcal{C}$ and $\mathcal{D}$, then let X_0 be functors and X_1 be *natural* transformations.

Example 4.9 Consider the functor Ring $\to$ Group which sends a ring to $\text{GL}(R)$. Then we can consider, $\det_n : \text{GL}_n(-) \implies (-)^\times$

For a category $\mathcal{C}$ we can define $\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}$ which swaps d_0 and d_1.

Definition 4.10 Consider the following functor,
$$F : \mathcal{C} \to \text{Fun}(\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set})$$

Theorem 4.11 **(Yoneda Lemma)**
$$\text{Hom}_{\text{Fun}(\mathcal{C}^{\text{op}}, \text{Set})}(\text{Hom}(-, x), F) \cong F(x)$$

Proof. Given a natural transformation $\mu : \mathrm{Hom}(-, x) \to F$, naturality for any morphism $f : y \to x$ yields the commutative square:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{Hom}(x,x) & \xrightarrow{\mu_x} & F(x) \\ {\scriptstyle f\circ -}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F(f)} \\ \mathrm{Hom}(y,x) & \xrightarrow{\mu_y} & F(y) \end{array}$$

Tracing elements through the diagram:

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathrm{id}_x & \longmapsto & \mu_x(\mathrm{id}_x) \\ {\scriptstyle f}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle F(f)} \\ f & \longmapsto & \mu_y(f) \end{array}$$

This forces $\mu_y(f) = F(f)(\mu_x(\mathrm{id}_x))$, meaning the entire natural transformation is uniquely determined by the single element $\mu_x(\mathrm{id}_x) \in F(x)$.

Conversely, any element $c \in F(x)$ defines a valid natural transformation via $\mu_y(f) = F(f)(c)$.

Thus, the assignment $\mu \mapsto \mu_x(\mathrm{id}_x)$ is a bijection, proving the isomorphism. ■

4.1 Yoneda Applications

4.1.1 Polynomial Forms

Remark 4.12 *This part is based on a note by Terence Tao*

Let us try to prove the following result,

Theorem 4.13 Given maps f_R for every ring R, such that for any ring R and a homomorphism $\varphi : R \to S$ one has that $f_S \circ \varphi = \varphi \circ f_R$ it must be that f is the polynomial map (intepreting R is a $\mathbb{Z}$-module).

Proof. Consider the forgetfull functor F (from Ring to Set which forgets the algebraic structure of the ring and reduces it to only its elements), then we can intepret the maps f_R as simply a *natural transformation* from F to F, since,

$$\begin{array}{ccc} R \\ {\scriptstyle \varphi}\downarrow \\ S \end{array} \qquad\qquad \begin{array}{ccc} R' & \xrightarrow{f_R} & R' \\ {\scriptstyle \varphi}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle \varphi} \\ S' & \xrightarrow{f_S} & S' \end{array}$$

any map $\varphi : R \to S$ per definition induces the commutative square above on the elements of Set (for notational purposes X' represents a set and X a ring).

Now, let us try to understand what is the F functor in another way,

Lemma 4.14 $F(R) \longleftrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Ring}}(\mathbb{Z}[x], R)$

This is simply the evaluation map, clearly it has a well-defined inverse since if $\mathbb{Z}[x] \xrightarrow{g} R$ is a homomorphism we only need to look at the image of x to uniquely determine g! □

Thus, the problem is to show that there is a bijection,

$$F(\mathbb{Z}[x]) \longleftrightarrow \mathrm{Nat}(\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathrm{Ring}}(\mathbb{Z}[x], -), F)$$

however this follows from Yoneda! ■

Let us now attempt to rewrite this proof by substituting the proof of Yoneda and avoid the utilization of terminology from category theory. The only real idea of the Yoneda lemma is the map defined via $\mu \to \mu(\mathrm{Id}_x)$.

Proof. Observe that f induces a homomorphism between $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ and $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ (the $f_{\mathbb{Z}[x]}$ map), however $\mathbb{Z}[x]$ can be identified with $\mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}[x], \mathbb{Z}[x])$ (given by the evaluation map), thus $f_{\mathbb{Z}[x]}$ gives rise to a map,

$$g : \mathrm{Hom}(\mathbb{Z}[x], \mathbb{Z}[x]) \longrightarrow \mathbb{Z}[x]$$

let $\omega_f = g(\mathrm{Id})$, or in other words $\omega_f = f(x)$. Let us define function $\mu : f \to \mathbb{Z}[x]$ as $\mu(f) = \omega_f$ and show it is bijective.

Injectivity follows from the commutative square,

$$\begin{array}{ccc} \mathbb{Z}[x] & \xrightarrow{f_{\mathbb{Z}[x]}} & \mathbb{Z}[x] \\ {\scriptstyle\varphi}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle\varphi} \\ R & \xrightarrow{f_R} & R \end{array} \quad \text{and} \quad \begin{array}{ccc} x & \xmapsto{f_{\mathbb{Z}[x]}} & f(x) \\ {\scriptstyle\varphi}\downarrow & & \downarrow{\scriptstyle\varphi} \\ \varphi(x) & \xmapsto{f_R} & f_R(\varphi(x)) \end{array}$$

thus any value is uniquely determined by ω_f.

Surjectivity also trivially follows from replacing $f(x)$ in the diagram with an arbitrary polynomial in $\mathbb{Z}[x]$!

Thus, we have shown a bijection between all possible f's and the polynomials in $\mathbb{Z}[x]$, clearly from the definitions this implies the desired result! ■

4.1.2 Graph-Theoretic Trivialities

Remark 4.15 Based on this insightful post.

Here is another silly application.

Observe that a graph is actually a functor from from the two-point category $\mathcal{C}$ to Set, since a graph can be represented as a bipartite graph with nodes in one of the partites and edges in the other, then the two morphisms will define the start and end of each edge.

By Yoneda we have that for $X \in \mathcal{C}$ (let us choose it to be the edges partite),

$$F(X) \longleftrightarrow \mathrm{Nat}(\mathrm{Hom}(X, -), F)$$

let us try to understand what are the natural transformations, clearly this represents a graph embedding. In other words this bijection is saying that there is a natural bijection between the edges of a graph and the ways to embed a *single edge* into the graph.

4.1.3 Cayley's Embedding Theorem

Let us now introduce several definitions,

Definition 4.16 A functor $F : \mathcal{C} \to \mathcal{D}$ is *fully faithful* if for any $X, Y \in \mathcal{C}$ the induced map,

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{C}}(X, Y) \longleftarrow \mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{D}}(F(X), F(Y))$$

is a bijection.

Observe that,

Theorem 4.17 The Yoneda embedding (functor from $\mathcal{C}^{\mathrm{op}} \to \mathrm{Set}$ given by $\mathrm{Hom}(-, x)$ for a specific x) is *fully faithful*.

Proof. Observe,

$$\mathrm{Hom}(\mathrm{Hom}(-, X), \mathrm{Hom}(-, Y)) \leftrightarrow \mathrm{Hom}(X, Y)$$

follows from Yoneda by applying it to $F = \mathrm{Hom}(-, Y)$! ■

Let us now prove the following famous result,

Theorem 4.18 Every finite group G is a subgroup of some symmetric group S_n.

Proof. Let us represent the abelian group G as a one-point category $\mathcal{G}$ consisting of a single object $*$, where the set of morphisms is $\mathrm{Hom}(*, *) = G$ and composition is given by the group operation:

$$\overset{g \in G}{\circlearrowleft} \quad * \quad \overset{h \in G}{\circlearrowright}$$

The Yoneda embedding gives a fully faithful functor,

$$h : \mathcal{G} \to \mathrm{Fun}(\mathcal{G}^{\mathrm{op}}, \mathrm{Set})$$

Since h is *fully faithful*, it induces a bijection (and thus an injective group homomorphism),

$$\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{G}}(*, *) \xrightarrow{\cong} \mathrm{Nat}(h(*), h(*))$$

however we know that $\mathrm{Hom}_{\mathcal{G}}(*, *) = G$, and $h(*)$ maps the single element to the set of G and the natural transformations correspond to endomorphisms on G. Since multiplication by an element in G is some permutation of the group, it clearly follows that $G \hookrightarrow S_G$, which proves the desired result! ■

Remark 4.19 Observe that the Yoneda lemma allowed us to find a bijection between the elements of G and the endomorphisms, of course another way to prove the result without Yoneda would be to directly show that $f(x) = gx$ for $g \in G$ determine unique

bijections (permutations) on the underlying set of G.

§5 All the Hilberts...

5.1 Hilbert's Basis Theorem

First, let us show that the chain condition definition of a Noetherian ring is equivalent to every ideal being finitely generated.

Proposition 5.1 The two following definitions of a Noetherian ring are equivalent,

1. Every ascending chain of ideals $Z_1 \subseteq Z_2 \subseteq Z_3 \subseteq \dots$ stabilizes.
2. Every ideal is finitely generated.

Proof. To show (1) implies (2), simply consider the following process of starting with an empty ideal I and then iteratively adding elements in $A \setminus I$ as generators, then let I_x be the ideal obtained after the xth step. This process induces an ascending chain,

$$I_0 \subseteq I_1 \subseteq I_2 \subseteq \dots$$

which must stabilize, thus proving that I is finitely generated!

The (2) implies (1), let $Z = \bigcup_{i=1}^{\infty} Z_i$, which clearly is an ideal (verify this!) and thus finitely generated, since each generator will appear somewhere in the chain it follows that some Z_k will contain all the generators and thus imply that the chain stabilized! ■

Theorem 5.2 If A is Noetherian, then $A[x]$ is as well.

Proof. Let us initiate a process, where we start with the empty ideal I and then iteratively add generators by finding lowest degree polynomials f that are not in I. Let a_i be the coefficient in front of the largest exponent monomial of f_i, then since A is Noetherian we may choose a large enough k such that $(a_1, \dots, a_k) = A$.

Thus, we may write $a_{k+1} = \sum_{i=1}^{k} b_i a_i$. Let $f \in A[x] \setminus I$ be the lowest of such degree, then consider the following peculiar function,

$$g(x) = f_{k+1}(x) - \sum_{i=1}^{k} b_i f_i \cdot x^{\deg f_{k+1} - \deg f_i}$$

clearly all the exponents are non-negative since at each step the lowest degree function not present in I was added. Observe that $\deg g < \deg f_{k+1}$ since the largest exponent monomial in f_{k+1} will be canceled by the sum of $b_i a_i$ coefficients, however clearly $g(x) \notin I$ (since $f_{k+1} \notin I$), thus contradicting the minimality of f_{k+1}! ■

5.2 Noether Normalization Theorem

Let us prove the following result,

Theorem 5.3 Let k be a field, and let A be a finitely generated k-algebra. Then there exist algebraically independent elements $y_1, \dots, y_d \in A$ such that the polynomial ring $k[y_1, \dots, y_d]$ injects into A,

$$k[y_1, \dots, y_d] \hookrightarrow A,$$

and A is integral (and finitely generated as a module) over $k[y_1, \dots, y_d]$.

Proof. Let $A = k[x_1, \dots, x_k]/I$ (since A is finitely generated), let us now consider some polynomial $P(X) = \sum_{i=0}^{n} \alpha_i X^i$, where $\alpha_i \in k$, by Euclid we know that $k[x_1, \dots, x_k] = k[x_1 - x_k^m, x_2 - x_k^m, \dots, x_{k-1} - x_k^m, x_k^m]$ (let $S_i = x_i - x_k^m$), thus we may rewrite P as,

$$P(x) = \sum_{i=0}^{n} \alpha_i X^i = \sum_{i=0}^{n} \alpha_i (S_1 + x_k^m)^{\alpha_{i1}} \dots (S_{k-1} + x_k^m)^{\alpha_{i(k-1)}} x_k^{\alpha_{ik}}$$

by choosing m large enough we may force the polynomial to be monic in x_k (it will have a coefficient in k which is a field, thus all coefficients are units). Thus, we obtain that A is integral over $k[S_1, \dots, S_k]$ and thus it is integral over $k[S_1, \dots, S_{k-1}]/(I \cap k[x_1, \dots, x_k])$ and consequently we may repeat this until we quotient by an empty ideal by induction! ■

5.3 Hilbert's Nullstellensatz

Let us first show a rather fundamental result about finite extensions.

Proposition 5.4 Let $S \subseteq R$ be two commutative rings, then if R is a finitely generated S-module, it must be that R is integral over S.

Proof. Let $u \in R$, then consider the sequence $u, u^2, u^3, \dots$, since R is finitely generated there must be some linear relationship between $\{u, \dots, u^n\}$ (choosing the smallest n with a linear relationship) that gives,

$$u^n - \sum_{i=1}^{n-1} \alpha_i u^i = 0, \text{ where } \alpha_i \in S$$

which is a monic polynomial with a root u! ■

First let us show the *weak* version of the theorem, (called *The Weak Hilbert Theorem*)

Theorem 5.5 If k is an algebraically closed field, then the maximal ideals $\mathfrak{m}$ of $k[x_1, \dots, x_k]$ correspond to points in k^n, so that,

$$k[x_1, \dots, x_k] \supseteq \mathfrak{m} = (x_1 - a_1, x_2 - a_2, \dots, x_k - a_k)$$

The proof will require to show that $k[x_1, \ldots, x_k]/\mathfrak{m} \cong k$, then looking at the images of x_i, let us assume that $x_i \mapsto \alpha_i$, we will deduce that it must be that $x_i - \alpha_i \mapsto 0$, which will imply that $(x_1 - \alpha_1, x_2 - \alpha_2, \ldots, x_k - \alpha_k) \subseteq \mathfrak{m}$, however since both are maximal ideals equality will follow!

To show the isomorphism we need to prove the following result,

Proposition 5.6 Let A be a finitely generated k-algebra (over algebraically closed field) and $\mathfrak{m}$ a maximal ideal of A, then $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is integral over k.

Proof. By **Noethers Normalization Lemma** $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is integral over $k[x_1, x_2, \ldots, x_k]$ for some $k \in \mathbb{Z}$, where $k = \dim A/\mathfrak{m} = 0$, thus we obtain the desired result! ■

Another way to proving this result without utilizing the formula for k is the following,

Proof. By **Noethers Normalization Lemma**, we have an injective homorphism $k[x_1, \ldots, x_k] \hookrightarrow A/\mathfrak{m}$, then consider the image of x_1 in this map, since $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is a field it has an inverse $1/x_1$ (slight abuse of notation for the image of x_1), then since $A/\mathfrak{m}$ is integral over $k[x_1, \ldots, x_k]$ we have some monic polynomial with root $1/x_1$,

$$\left(\frac{1}{x_1}\right)^n + Q_{n-1} \cdot \left(\frac{1}{x_1}\right)^{n-1} + \ldots + Q_1 \cdot \left(\frac{1}{x}\right) + Q_0 = 0$$

multiplying this equation by x_1^n one obtains,

$$1 + x_1 Q_{n-1} + \ldots + x_1^{n-1} Q_1 + x_1^n = 1 + x_1 \cdot Q = 0$$

thus x_1 is invertible in $k[x_1, \ldots, x_k]$, which is of course nonsense, thus $k = 0$! ■

A very nice consequence of *Weak Nullstellensatz* is the following corrolary,

Proposition 5.7 If $I \subseteq k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$ has no common roots, then I is the entire ideal.

Proof. Since every ideal is part of a maximal ideal, which has has a common root given by the point it corresponds to, thus it must be the entire ideal! ■

Let $V(I)$ be the set of common zeros of all the polynomials in I and $Z(J)$ be the set of polynomials vanishing on $J \subseteq k^n$. It turns out the following result holds,

Theorem 5.8 For any ideal $I \subseteq k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$ we have that,

$$Z(V(I)) \cong \sqrt{I}$$

where $\sqrt{I}$ denotes the radical of I.

Proof. It is clear that $\sqrt{I} \subseteq Z(V(I))$, since the zeros of p^n are the same as p. To show the other direction, one can utlize the so called *Rabinowitsch trick*.

Let $p \in Z(V(I))$, the idea is that we can map $I \subseteq k[x_1, \ldots, x_n]$ into $k[x_1, \ldots, x_n, y]$ by considering,

$$J = I \cdot k[x_1, \ldots, x_n] + (1 - yp)$$

The zeros of J must be those that all polynomials in I vanish on the first coordinates and $1 - yp = 0$, so $yp = 1$, however since p vanishes on all common zeros it must be that $p = 0$, thus there are no zeros! By the *Weak Nullstellensatz* this implies that $1 \in J$, thus,

$$1 = \sum_i f_i h_i(x_1, \ldots, x_n, y) + (1 - yp) h_{n+1}(x_1, \ldots, x_n, y)$$

now we take $y = \frac{1}{p}$, then multiplying by a sufficiently large power of p, we will obtain that,

$$p^n = \sum_i f_i H_i(x_1, \ldots, x_n)$$

which proves that $p \in \sqrt{I}$! ■